

THE DORMITION FAST: TWO WEEKS WITH THE THEOTOKOS

SESSION 00.14 HANDOUT

NAME _____ DATE _____

♦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

These are the Theotokos's own words, sung at the Annunciation when she carried Christ in her womb for the first time. *All generations* — including your generation, including you, this August — call her blessed. The Dormition Fast is one way we keep that prophecy. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

For He has regarded the lowly state of His maidservant; for behold, henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. — Luke 1:48

♦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

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|-----------------|---|---|--|
| DORMITION FAST | • | • | Greek for <i>falling asleep</i> — the Orthodox name for the Theotokos's death. She did not die the way others die; her Son carried her home. |
| DORMITION | • | • | The feast on August 6, in the middle of the Dormition Fast — the day Christ's glory shone on Mount Tabor. Fish is allowed. |
| TRANSFIGURATION | • | • | The two weeks of fasting from August 1 through August 14 in honor of the Theotokos, leading to her great feast on August 15. |
| LAMENTATIONS OF | • | • | The funeral-shaped service some Orthodox the Theotokos parishes hold on the Friday after August 15, mirroring Holy Friday's lamentations for Christ — but sung now for His Mother. |

♦ CALENDAR — THE TWO WEEKS WITH THE THEOTOKOS

Below is the calendar of the Dormition Fast. Fill in what happens on each marked date using the word bank.

Word bank: *Fast begins · Transfiguration (fish allowed) · Fast ends · Dormition (great feast)*

DATE	WHAT HAPPENS
August 1	_____
August 2-5	Quieter meals. Lentils. Beans. Fewer fast-breaking foods.
August 6	_____
August 7-13	Back to the fast. Wednesday and Friday especially marked.
August 14	_____
August 15	_____

✦ SKETCH — THE THEOTOKOS AT SJTD

Find the icon of the Theotokos behind the altar at SJTD (the *Platytera* — *More Spacious than the Heavens*) and the icon of the Dormition that may be displayed prominently this week. Draw a simple side-by-side below.

THE THEOTOKOS PLATYTERA

(behind the altar — always)



She is **standing**, arms raised in prayer, with the infant Christ in a circle on her chest.

THE DORMITION

(brought out for her feast week)



She is **lying** on a bier as if asleep, with the Apostles around her and Christ behind, holding her soul.

✦ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

The lesson said: *every fast belongs to someone*. The Apostles' Fast you kept in June belonged to Peter and Paul. The Dormition Fast you just kept belonged to your Mother. Write 3 to 5 sentences. What was different about fasting *for her*? Did the fact that you were fasting *for someone* — your Mother — change how you felt about it? *It's okay if it didn't feel different. It's okay if you mostly noticed being hungry. The fast was still hers, and you walked through it.*
